CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Railways did NOT mainly benefit Indians because 1

(a) lines were planned for British trade and defence
(b) they stopped taxes
(c) they were free
(d) they linked all villages

2. British success in India was helped mainly by 1

(a) divide and rule and military strength **(b)** free trade
(c) Indian unity **(d)** lack of weapons

3. Why did the Company's private army matter? 1

(a) It let a trading firm win battles and control territory
(b) It stopped trade
(c) It built schools
(d) It protected temples

4. Tribal revolts like the Santhal were caused by 1

(a) railways only
(b) trade
(c) moneylenders, landlords and colonial laws
(d) rain

5. Which is an unintended effect of colonial rule? 1

(a) Less railways
(b) More trade
(c) Spread of new ideas leading to nationalism
(d) End of English

6. Siraj-ud-daulah lost at Plassey chiefly because 1

(a) his army was larger **(b)** he did not fight
(c) his commander betrayed him **(d)** he had no army

7. The Vellore Mutiny (1806) shows that 1

(a) there was no army
(b) discontent in the army existed before 1857
(c) the army was happy
(d) Plassey caused it

8. The Company moved from trade to rule because 1

(a) the Mughals asked
(b) its ships failed
(c) it gained revenue rights and used military power
(d) Indians demanded it

9. The Subsidiary Alliance weakened rulers because 1

(a) they got free troops
(b) they hired Resident
(c) they paid for troops that controlled them
(d) they gained territory

10. Historians call 1857 a 'rebellion' because 1

(a) only sepoys fought
(b) it was peaceful
(c) it was small
(d) many sections of society joined

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why did Santhals revolt? 2

12. How did famine policy worsen the Bengal famine? 2

13. Why was the Doctrine of Lapse unpopular? 2

14. Why is 1857 called a great rebellion? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain the role of Plassey in establishing British power. 3

16. How did the British change village governance? 3

17. Describe the outcome of the 1857 rebellion. 3

OR

Explain the ways the British gained territories without war. 3

18. Describe how railways served British economic interests. 3

OR

Explain the unintended outcomes of colonial rule. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Explain the economic impact of British rule on India. 5

OR

Explain how famines were made worse by policy, with two examples. 5

20. Discuss how colonial education and governance transformed Indian society. 5

OR

Describe the contribution of women such as Abbakka, Lakshmibai and Hazrat Mahal. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks